

```
and testing utility
Repo      : base
Matched from:
Filename  : /usr/bin/mkpasswd
```

This lists the package that contains the 'mkpasswd' binary.



Note: If you are searching for a third party binary/command, then make sure you've enabled third party repositories like too.

—Naresh Kumar, nareshkumarvn@gmail.com



Deleting a lot of files from a Linux directory

When we have a lot of files in a directory, regular commands such as `rm *` fail, giving the following error:

```
"argument list too long"
```

This is because the `*` is replaced by the list of all file names in that directory before the `rm` command gets executed.

If it is okay to rename the directory and create a new one with the same name, permissions and ownerships, then this is one way of doing it. Ensure the relevant services which use this directory are restarted in this case.

If it is not okay to rename the directory, we can use the `Find` command as follows from within that directory:

```
find . -delete
```

The above command is much faster than the following:

```
find . -exec rm {} \;
```

If we want to remove only the files but not directories, use the command given below:

```
find . -type f -delete
```

One common scenario in which this is helpful is when removing a lot of spam mails from a mail directory.

—Sisirkumar K, info@theuxgroup.com



Setting a process for CPU affinity

CPU affinity means binding a process to a given set of CPUs. Let us check the CPU affinity for a process. First, let's find the PID of the process to be checked. In the case of my example, the PID is 22353 and its CPU affinity is set to CPU 0.

```
[root@Linux-Test1 ~]# ps -a
```

```
PID TTY      TIME CMD
22353 pts/1    00:00:02 dd
```

Now let's check the affinity, using the following code:

```
[root@Linux-Test1 ~]# taskset -cp 22353
pid 22353's current affinity list: 0
```

The example below shows how to change the CPU affinity of a running process to CPU 1.

```
[root@Linux-Test1 ~]# taskset -pc 1 22353
pid 22353's current affinity list: 0
pid 22353's new affinity list: 1
```

To run a new program on a specific CPU, use the following commands:

```
#taskset -c 0 myscript.sh      <-- This will run the
script on CPU 0.
#taskset -c 0,1 myscript.sh    <-- In this case it will
use multiple cores[CPU 0 &1].
#taskset -c 0-4 myscript.sh    <-- It will run on
multiple cores [CPU 0,1,2,3].
```

Hope this information on CPU affinity will help you run an application on multi-core processors.

—Sumit Chauhan, sumit1203@gmail.com



Back up and restore file permissions

Here is a tip to back up and restore file permissions in Linux.

To take a backup, go to the required directory (here we take /) and use the following command:

```
getfacl -R . > permissions.txt
```

To restore a file, use:

```
setfacl --restore=permissions.txt
```

—Natraj Solai, linuxraja@gmail.com



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